



Even something like learning to type may give a child that little edge

and make rapid decisions, we can't overlook the fact that kids doing this regularly have trouble focusing on schoolwork and homework or seeing complex tasks through to completion. There's plenty of research telling us how and why concentrating on one task is better than doing 2-3 things at a time. If your kids are eating while watching television or movies on their gadgets they're not paying complete attention to either task.

Are they videogames or mind games?

Speaking of the ability to make rapid decisions, let's talk about videogames and gaming apps for a bit. According to an AC Nielson survey, by the time a child finishes primary school, s/he will have already witnessed 8,000 murders and 20-25 acts of violence each hour. Yes, this is children targeted media we're talking about. Also, simply because the title has the word "game" in it, doesn't immediately qualify it as such for everyone. The reasons for the age rating on games are the same as those for movies – violence, sex, nudity, gore, drug use and profanity. You wouldn't let your kid watch an R-rated movie, why would you allow her to play games targeted at an older group?

The damage continues...

Each minute spent playing games on a gadget is taken away from the time